

Maury County, TN – Quick-Take “Tower Cheat-Sheet”

Requirement	What the Ordinance Says	Key Source
Setbacks / Fall Zone	Tower must sit far enough back so its <i>entire</i> fall radius = 100 % of tower height to every adjoining property line (or to any other tower’s structural base). In plain English: if the pole is 250 ft tall, keep every property line ≥ 250 ft away.	
Height Limits	No fixed numeric cap in the zoning text. The Board of Zoning Appeals (BZA) reviews height case-by-case and requires a “ Determination of No Hazard ” from the FAA plus FCC compliance. Height is therefore functionally limited by: (a) your parcel’s ability to satisfy the 100 % fall radius, and (b) FAA/FCC rulings.	
Where Can You Build? (Zoning Districts)	Communication towers are listed as “ communication services and communication-equipment installation ”—a Special Exception use—in every major base district: A-1, A-2, A-2A, C-1, C-2, C-3, M-1, M-2, and M-3 (plus any PUD overlay). Agricultural, commercial, and industrial dirt are all in play, but the BZA must bless the site.	A-1 • A-2 • C-2 (example) • M-1/M-2
Public Hearing & Neighbor Notice	Yes. Property owners within 500 ft get a mailed notice 7 days before the BZA meeting; the BZA hearing itself is public.	 Sources
If the BZA Says “No” – Appeal Path	Decisions of the BZA may be appealed to Maury County Chancery Court within 30 days pursuant to Article VIII (Variance/Special-Exception appeals follow Tenn. Code §27-9-114).	
Permit / Approval Shelf-Life	BZA Special-Exception approval expires after 12 months if you haven’t “gone vertical.” Pull your building permit and start construction within that window or you’re back to square one.	

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Building-Permit Validity	The zoning ordinance no longer sets a separate clock, so Maury County follows the 2018 International Building Code § 105.5: a building permit lapses if work doesn't <i>start</i> or later <i>stalls</i> for ≥ 180 days . Stay busy and you're fine. (County staff confirms the same practice.)	
Planning & Zoning Contacts	Maury County Building & Zoning Office • 10 Public Sq., 2nd Floor, Columbia TN 38401 • ☎ 931-375-3002	

Quick-Hit Takeaways 🏃 ⚙

1. **Parcel size matters** – your lot must be big enough to swallow a fall zone equal to tower height on *all sides*.
2. **No hard height cap** – tallest stick wins *if* FAA + fall zone clear.
3. **Special-Exception everywhere** – plan on a BZA hearing, neighbor notices, and conditions.
4. **12-month clock** – break ground (or at least set the caisson) within a year of BZA approval.
5. **Keep the permit alive** – don't let construction sit idle > 180 days.

Need help packaging this into your SCIP or prepping the BZA submittal? Holler and we'll crank out the exhibits. Rock on, BroSlice! 🙌